

What is letter?

- ▶ **“A written or printed communication directed to a person or organization.”**
- ▶ It is used to convey message.
- ▶ It may be formal or informal.
- ▶ It has played an important role in society.



Before writing a letter

- ▶ **Identify** your audience and purpose in order to determine the type of letter you will write (formal or informal).
- ▶ **Examine** the **tone** of the letter to which you are going to respond.
- ▶ **Analyze your reader:**
 - ▶ Who is your reader?
 - ▶ Will my reader be favorable or unfavorably disposed to what I am going to say?
 - ▶ What impression do I want my letter to make on reader?



Informal letters

- ▶ These are the letters which keep us in touch with family and friends.
- ▶ These are usually chatty and informal.
- ▶ When we need to communicate a lot of information.
- ▶ When we want to communicate something that is difficult to say face to face.
- ▶ To mark some special occasion.

Formal letters

- ▶ Formal letters are letters to people whom we don't know on personal level.
- ▶ To find out information.
- ▶ To apply for a job.
- ▶ To make a complaint.
- ▶ Writing to someone professional.
- ▶ Requesting something.



Personal letters

- ▶ A type of letter (or informal composition) that usually concerns personal matters, rather than professional concerns and is sent from one individual to another.
- ▶ It is a kind of letter that we write to our
 - ▶ Parents
 - ▶ Close relatives
 - ▶ Close friends
- ▶ Friendly letters convey personal information about ourselves.
- ▶ They show caring and concern for friends and relations.
- ▶ Taking the time to hand-write a letter demonstrates our level of caring

Family
and
Friends



Personal letter features

- ▶ The writer's address.
- ▶ Date.
- ▶ Address of recipient.
- ▶ A salutation.
- ▶ The body of letter.
- ▶ A complementary close.
- ▶ Writer's sign.
- ▶ Typed name.

Letter format



Things to remember while writing a letter

- ▶ If you're writing to anyone with whom you hope to have a professional relationship, the letter should be **formal**.
- ▶ If you're writing someone you know very well, the letter should probably be **informal**.
- ▶ Start with a **salutation** i.e Dear, Respected, Sir, etc.
- ▶ Use a complimentary close i.e Sincerely yours, Kindest regards, etc.